

IN PRACTICE

Three ways to break the symmetry

The matched pair

Two identical lamps flanking a console is a hotel. Keep one; replace the other with something of a different height in the same tone. The eye relaxes the moment the symmetry breaks.

The centred art

A print hung dead-centre on a wall reads as a diagram. Shift it off to one side, weighted by an object below; the wall becomes a composition.

The flawless set

A perfectly matching dinner service feels bought. Reactive-glaze stoneware, where every piece varies, feels gathered over time — even when it arrived in one box.

